

Welcome to PicOrg

PicOrg helps you get organised with the photos already on your computer. You point it at a folder, and it shows you every picture inside — big or small, one or thousands. From there you can:

- Give photos a **name** and a **star rating** (like your favourite song list).
- Add **tags** — short labels like `beach`, `Christmas`, or `Mum` — so you can find groups of photos in seconds later on.
- Write a short **comment** on any photo you want to remember something about.
- Delete the ones you don't want any more.

Everything stays on your computer. Nothing is uploaded, no account is needed, and you can keep using PicOrg with no internet connection.

Why use PicOrg?

Most people end up with photos scattered across folders like `Camera Roll`, `iPhone Backup 2019`, and `Family - Copy (2)`. Windows gives you those folders and not much more. PicOrg gives you a proper way to sort through them:

- **Find things fast.** Type `beach` in the search box and every beach photo shows up, no matter which folder it's in.
- **Keep your keepers.** Give the good ones five stars, ignore the rest.
- **Nothing gets moved.** Your files stay exactly where they are on disk. Tags and ratings are saved *inside* the photo file itself (in the same standard place Windows Explorer uses), so no extra files clutter your folders.

A quick tour, in under two minutes

1. **Click “+ Add folder”** at the top of the window and pick a folder full of photos. PicOrg gets to work reading everything it finds.
2. **Scroll** through the photos in the big central area — it stays smooth even with tens of thousands of pictures.
3. **Click a photo** to open the details panel on the right. Type a title. Click a star. Add a tag. Everything saves as you go — there's no “Save” button to remember.

4. **Hold Ctrl while clicking** to pick several photos at once, then add the same tag to all of them.
5. **Type in the search box** at the top to find photos by their tag, title, comment, or filename.

That's the whole app in a nutshell. The rest of this manual explains each part in a bit more detail.

What PicOrg is *not*

- **Not a photo editor.** It won't crop, straighten, brighten, or filter your photos. Use another app for that.
- **Not a backup service.** Your photos stay on your computer. If your hard drive fails, PicOrg can't help — copy your photos somewhere safe (an external drive, OneDrive, etc.).
- **Not a face-recogniser.** It won't guess who's in your photos or auto-tag them.

If you want any of those, PicOrg is happy to sit next to whichever tool does them for you — it won't get in the way.

Installing and launching PicOrg

What you need

- A PC running **Windows 10** or **Windows 11**.
- About **50 MB of free space** for the app.
- A little extra space for small thumbnail images (roughly 100 MB for every 10,000 photos).

That's it. No account, no internet connection, no subscription.

Installing

Depending on where you got PicOrg from, you'll have one of these:

- **An installer** (a file ending in `.msi` or `.exe`). Double-click it and follow the prompts. When Windows asks whether to allow the installer to make changes, click **Yes**.
- **A portable version** (just `picorg.exe`). Copy it wherever you like — for example, `C:\Programs\PicOrg\` — and double-click it to launch. No installation needed.

If Windows shows a blue “Windows protected your PC” screen, click **More info** and then **Run anyway**. This happens with any small app that hasn't paid Microsoft for a code signature — it doesn't mean anything is wrong.

The very first time you open it

When you first start PicOrg you'll see:

- An empty window with a friendly **“Add folder”** button.
- The status bar at the bottom saying **Idle**.

Nothing is scanned yet. Nothing is stored yet. PicOrg is waiting for you to point it at a folder of photos.

The [next chapter](#) walks you through that in detail.

What PicOrg creates on your computer

PicOrg keeps its own little workshop in a hidden Windows folder. You don't need to open it or think about it — but if you're curious, it's here:

```
C:\Users\<you>\AppData\Roaming\com.picorg.picorg\
```

That folder contains PicOrg's own database (an index of the photos it knows about) and small thumbnail previews. **None of your original photos live there** — they stay exactly where you put them.

Uninstalling

- Installed with an `.msi` ? Open **Settings > Apps > Installed apps**, find PicOrg, and click **Uninstall**.
- Portable version? Just delete `picorg.exe` .

To also wipe PicOrg's own files, delete the hidden folder above (in File Explorer, paste `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg` into the address bar). **Your photos and any tags you added to them are safe** — those live in your photo folders, not in PicOrg's workshop.

Adding your first folder

PicOrg needs to know which folders on your computer contain the photos you want to organise. Once you tell it, it does the rest.

Add a folder in three clicks

1. Click **+ Add folder** at the top of the window.
2. In the dialog that opens, browse to the folder that has your photos — for example `C:\Users\me\Pictures\Vacation 2024`.
3. Click **Select folder**.

That's it. PicOrg starts looking through the folder right away. The bar at the bottom of the window shows what's happening ("Reading 234 of 1,205 photos...") and updates as it goes.

You don't have to wait for it to finish — photos appear in the window as they're found, so you can start browsing (and even tagging) straight away.

What PicOrg does when you add a folder

Behind the scenes, PicOrg:

- **Looks in the folder and every folder inside it.** So adding `Pictures` also picks up `Pictures\2020`, `Pictures\Kids`, and so on.
- **Reads the date each photo was taken**, the camera used, and the size of the image.
- **Reads any tags, ratings, or titles** already saved with the photo (for example, tags you added earlier in Windows Explorer).
- **Makes small thumbnail previews** so the grid loads instantly, even for very large libraries.

Your original photos are **not moved, renamed, or changed** in any way during this. PicOrg only reads them.

Adding more folders

You can add as many folders as you like — one for your holidays, one for family, one for work photos, whatever suits you.

Every folder you add appears under **Library › Folders** in the left-hand sidebar. Click a folder name there to see only the photos inside that folder.

Removing a folder

Right-click the folder name in the sidebar and choose **Remove from library**. PicOrg forgets about it — but **your photos stay on your computer**. Removing a folder from PicOrg is not the same as deleting it from your PC.

Refreshing when photos change

If you drop new photos into a folder using File Explorer, or edit some in another app, PicOrg doesn't know about it right away. To catch up:

- **Right-click a folder name** in the sidebar and choose **Rescan folder**, or
- Click **Rescan** at the top of the window to check every folder at once.

Rescanning is quick — PicOrg only looks at files that have changed since the last time it checked.

Browsing your library

The big area in the middle of the window is your **photo grid**. It shows every photo PicOrg knows about, all in one long scrollable page. Even with tens of thousands of photos, it stays smooth to scroll.

Picking photos

- **Click a photo** to select it. It gets a blue outline, and its details appear in the panel on the right.
- **Ctrl + click** more photos to add them to the selection.
- **Shift + click** somewhere else in the grid to grab everything between the first and the new click.
- **Ctrl + A** picks every photo currently shown.
- **Esc** unpicks everything.

The number of selected photos is shown in the panel on the right and in the status bar at the bottom.

Sorting the grid

There's a **Sort** menu in the top-right corner of the grid. Choose what makes sense for the moment:

- **Taken** — the day the photo was taken. Great for going through a trip in order.
- **Modified** — the day the file was last changed on your computer.
- **Filename** — A to Z by name.
- **Rating** — five-star photos first, unrated last. Useful when looking for your keepers.
- **Random** — shuffles the grid. Great for rediscovering old photos you'd forgotten about.

The little arrow next to the sort menu flips between ascending (oldest first) and descending (newest first).

The details panel on the right

Click a photo and its details appear in the panel on the right:

- A larger preview at the top.
- The **filename**, **date taken**, **camera**, **size**, and **dimensions**.
- A place to type in a **title**.
- **Star rating** (0 to 5).
- **Tags** you can add or remove.
- A **comment** field for notes to your future self.

Editing any of these saves automatically — you don't need a Save button. The next chapter, [Editing metadata](#), goes into detail.

If you pick more than one photo at once, the details panel switches into a batch mode — see [Working on many photos at once](#).

The sidebar filters

The list on the left is a set of filters — clicking one narrows down the grid to just matching photos.

- **Library › Folders**: show only photos from one specific folder on your computer.
- **Rating**: show only photos with at least so many stars. “3 stars and up” means 3, 4, and 5.
- **Tags**: show only photos with a specific tag. The number next to each tag is how many photos have that tag.

Filters stack. Click a folder **and** a rating **and** a tag and you see only photos that match all three. Add words to the search box at the top for even finer results.

Clearing filters

Click **All photos** at the top of the sidebar to start fresh — every filter is cleared in one click.

Searching and filtering

Once you've added tags and titles to a good number of photos, finding them again is a treat. Type a word or two in the search box at the top of the window and the grid narrows down to matching photos while you type.

What the search looks at

The search box looks in four places on every photo:

- The **title** you typed.
- The **tags** you added.
- The **comment** you wrote.
- The **filename** (like `IMG_4523.jpg`).

So if you type `sun`, PicOrg finds photos titled *Sunset*, tagged `sunny`, with a comment mentioning "sunrise", or in a file called `sunbathing.jpg`.

Capital letters don't matter: `Beach` and `beach` find the same photos. Accents don't matter either: `naïve` finds photos where you typed `naïve`.

Handy search tricks

- `beach vacation` — finds photos with **both** words somewhere.
- `beach OR mountain` — finds photos with **either** word.
- `vacation -beach` — vacation photos that are **not** tagged beach.
- `"family reunion"` — the exact phrase, in that order.

You can even start typing part of a word — `sun` matches `sunset`, `sunny`, `sunbathing`.

Search + sidebar filters = laser-focused

The search box works together with the filters on the left. For example, to find *the 5-star Iceland photos with the word "glacier" in the comment*:

1. Click the folder `Iceland` on the left.

2. Click **5 stars** in the Rating list.
3. Type `glacier` in the search box.

The grid updates instantly. When you're done, click **All photos** in the sidebar to reset everything.

Clearing the search

Click the little ✕ inside the search box to clear it — or press **Esc** while your cursor is inside the box. The sidebar filters stay where they were.

Nothing found?

If a search turns up empty and you were expecting results:

- Check for a typo. `caht` won't find `cat` photos.
- Try a shorter word. `mount` finds both `mountain` and `mountains`.
- Check the sidebar — you might have a filter active (like a rating or folder) that's excluding matches. Click **All photos** and try the search again.

Editing metadata

Metadata is a fancy word for “information about a photo” — its title, star rating, tags, comments. It’s what makes a folder of `IMG_1234.jpg` files feel like a real photo album.

To edit any of this, click one photo in the grid. The **details panel** on the right lights up with everything you can change.

What you can change

What	What it’s for
Title	A short name for the photo, like “Anna’s birthday cake”.
Rating	0 to 5 stars. Handy for marking your favourites.
Tags	Little labels like <code>beach</code> , <code>family</code> , <code>2024</code> , <code>black-and-white</code> .
Comment	Longer notes — who was there, what happened, what’s the story.

Everything saves as you type

There is **no Save button**. PicOrg saves your changes automatically:

- **Title and comment:** saved a moment after you stop typing (or as soon as you click somewhere else).
- **Rating and tags:** saved immediately when you click a star or finish typing a tag.

You’ll see a tiny “Saving...” note when it’s happening. It usually takes less than half a second.

Setting a title

Click the **Title** box, type a name, click somewhere else (or wait a moment). Done.

To clear a title, just erase what’s there.

Setting a star rating

Below the title, five stars are lined up. Click star **3** to give the photo three stars. Click star **1** to knock it down to one. To un-rate a photo entirely, **click the same star you already selected** — it toggles back to zero.

Adding tags

Click the **Tags** box. Type a word — for example `family` — and then press one of:

- **Space**
- **Enter**
- **Comma**

The tag becomes a little pill you can see. Type another word, press space, and there's another. Keep going for as many tags as you want.

While you type, PicOrg suggests tags you've already used elsewhere, so you don't end up with `Beach`, `beach`, and `beaches` all meaning the same thing. Use the arrow keys to pick a suggestion and press Enter.

To **remove a tag**, hover over its pill and click the little ✕.

Writing a comment

Click the **Comment** box and type. It's a longer field, good for a sentence or two. Perfect for stories that would be lost otherwise — "Grandpa laughing at his own joke" is a lot more useful than `IMG_1985.jpg`.

The info you can look at but not change

Below the editable fields you'll see:

- The **date taken** (from when the camera took the picture).
- The **camera make and model**.
- The photo's **size on disk** and **pixel dimensions**.
- The full **file path** — click it to see it in full and copy it if you need to.

These are read directly from the file. PicOrg doesn't let you edit them because they describe the photo itself, not your notes about it.

Working on many photos at once

Editing photos one at a time is fine when there are only a few. But when you have hundreds — say, an entire holiday — you'll want to tag or rate them in one go. PicOrg is built for exactly that.

Picking several photos

- **Click** the first photo.
- **Ctrl + click** each of the other photos you want to include.
- Or **Shift + click** at the far end to grab everything in between.
- **Ctrl + A** grabs every photo in the current view.

The details panel on the right immediately switches to a batch view that reads “*N photos selected*”. The number ticks up as you add more.

Rating them all at once

In batch mode there's a **Set rating** row of stars. Click star **4** and *every* photo you've selected gets four stars — instantly, no confirmation needed.

Click the leftmost empty spot to clear the rating on everything.

Adding tags to all of them

Batch mode shows two tag boxes instead of one:

- **Add tags** — anything you put here gets added to every selected photo. Photos that already had the tag are simply left alone.
- **Remove tags** — anything you put here gets removed from every selected photo.

You can queue up multiple tags before hitting the button. When you're ready, click **Apply tag changes to N photos**. A confirmation appears when it's done: “*Updated N photos.*”

Tip. Add tags in bulk first, then use the sidebar to check your work. Click the tag on the left — the grid narrows to just the photos that have it, and you can see whether everything

landed correctly.

Deleting them all at once

At the bottom of the details panel there's a red **Delete N photos** button. Click it, confirm the prompt, and the whole selection heads to the Recycle Bin. See [Deleting photos](#) for the full story.

What if one photo won't accept a change?

Sometimes a photo lives in a folder that's read-only (an old backup drive, for example). If PicOrg can't save a change to it, the other photos still get updated — you'll just see a message at the end telling you which ones didn't work.

Fix the permissions on that folder (right-click → Properties in File Explorer) and try again.

Tags: adding, renaming, cleaning up

Tags are little labels you stick on photos so you can find them later. There are no folders-inside-folders or complicated structures — tags are just words. A photo can have as many as you want.

Good tags are things you'd naturally think of later:

- **Places:** Iceland, beach, home.
- **People:** Emma, Grandad, the twins.
- **Events:** wedding, Christmas-2024, hike.
- **Feelings:** favourites, funny, to-print.

Adding tags

The most detailed walkthrough is in [Editing metadata](#). In short:

- Click the **Tags** box in the details panel.
- Type a word.
- Press **Space**, **Enter**, or **Comma** to save it.

Repeat as many times as you like. To **remove** a tag, click the little ✕ on its pill.

Capital letters don't matter — Beach and beach are treated as the same tag.

The tag list in the sidebar

Every tag you've ever used shows up in the **Tags** section of the sidebar on the left, in alphabetical order. Next to each tag is a number — how many photos carry that tag.

- **Click a tag** to filter the grid to only photos with that tag.
- **Right-click a tag** for two options: **Rename** and **Delete**.

Renaming a tag

Made a typo? Change your mind on capitalisation? Right-click the tag and choose **Rename tag**.... Type the new name and confirm.

PicOrg updates the tag on **every photo that had it**, all at once. There's no per-photo work to do.

Deleting a tag

Right-click the tag → **Delete tag**. This removes the tag from every photo — but it does not delete any photos. Only the label goes.

Autocompletion — save yourself typos

While you type a new tag, PicOrg shows a small dropdown of tags you've used before that start with the same letters. Use the arrow keys to pick one and press Enter. This is the easiest way to keep your tag list tidy — no more `beach`, `beaches`, `beach`, `beach-day`.

Tips for tagging a big library

- **Start broad.** Tag by place or year first — `Iceland`, `2024`. Once every photo has broad tags, narrow ones (`glacier`, `Reykjavik`) are easier because you can filter down first.
- **Use multi-select.** `Ctrl + click` many photos and add tags to them all in one go.
- **Don't over-tag.** A tag that's on 8,000 photos isn't very useful. When in doubt, pick tags that would show fewer than a few hundred results.

Do tags show up in other apps?

Yes. PicOrg saves tags in the same standard format that Windows Explorer, Adobe Lightroom, and other photo tools use. See [Interoperability with other tools](#) for the details.

Star ratings

A star rating is a simple 0-to-5 score you can give any photo. It’s the fastest way to say “this one’s a keeper” or “meh, skip it” as you flip through a shoot.

What the scores mean

The scale is entirely up to you. A common approach:

Stars	Meaning
★★★★★	The absolute best — print it, share it, brag about it.
★★★★	Really good. Worth keeping and showing off.
★★★	Fine. Keep it, but nothing special.
★★	Not great, but hard to delete just yet.
★	Almost certainly a reject — kept only “just in case”.
(none)	Not rated yet.

You don’t have to use all five levels. Many people only ever use 5 stars (favourites) and nothing else.

Rating a photo

Click a photo, look at the details panel on the right. Below the title you’ll see five little stars.

- **Click star 3** to give it three stars.
- **Click star 3 again** to reset back to no rating.

That’s it. The rating saves the moment you click.

Rating a whole shoot fast

Pick lots of photos at once ([Ctrl + click](#), or Shift + click a range) and use the **Set rating** row in the batch details panel. Every selected photo gets the same rating in one click. Perfect for “everything from Monday gets 3 stars, the ones I like will earn a 4 later”.

Showing only your favourites

The sidebar on the left has a **Rating** section with five entries:

- **5 stars** — only 5-star photos.
- **4 stars and up** — 4 and 5.
- **3 stars and up** — 3, 4, and 5.
- and so on.

Click one to filter the grid. To go back to everything, click **All photos** at the top.

Ratings you set here show up elsewhere

PicOrg writes ratings in the same standard format used by Windows, Lightroom, and other photo tools. If you rate a picture 4 stars in PicOrg, Windows Explorer’s Details tab and the Photos app will also show it as 4 stars. And ratings you set in those apps show up in PicOrg (rescan the folder to see them). More details in [Interoperability with other tools](#).

Deleting photos

Sooner or later you'll want to get rid of some photos — blurry shots, duplicates, that photo of a light switch from someone's pocket. PicOrg deletes them safely, with a confirmation, and puts them in the **Recycle Bin** so you can undo the deletion if you change your mind.

Deleting one photo

1. Click the photo in the grid.
2. Either:
 - Click the red **Delete image** button at the bottom of the details panel, **or**
 - Press the **Delete** key on your keyboard.
3. A prompt asks: *"Move IMG_2043.jpg to the Recycle Bin?"*.
4. Click **Move to Recycle Bin** to confirm — or **Cancel** to back out.

The photo disappears from PicOrg and lands in the Windows Recycle Bin.

Deleting many photos at once

1. Pick lots of photos with **Ctrl + click** or **Shift + click**.
2. Click **Delete N photos** at the bottom of the details panel (or press the **Delete** key).
3. Confirm the prompt.

What actually happens when you delete

- The photo is moved to the **Windows Recycle Bin** — the same Recycle Bin you already know.
- Any tags or ratings PicOrg had for that photo go with it.
- PicOrg forgets the photo (until you restore it — see below).

Nothing is deleted permanently — unless you tell it to (see the next section).

Getting a photo back after deleting

Made a mistake? No problem:

1. Double-click the **Recycle Bin** on your desktop.
2. Find your photo.
3. Right-click it → **Restore**.

The photo goes back exactly where it was. The next time you click **Rescan** in PicOrg, it reappears in the library with its tags, title, and rating still on it.

Permanently deleting (no safety net)

If you're absolutely sure a photo is gone-for-good, hold the **Shift** key while pressing Delete (or while clicking the delete button). The prompt will say *"Permanently delete"* instead of *"Move to Recycle Bin"*.

Warning. Permanent deletion cannot be undone. Do not use it unless you're 100% sure — and always keep a backup of important photos.

If in doubt, use the normal delete. You can always empty the Recycle Bin later.

What is *not* deleted

- **Removing a folder from PicOrg is not deleting.** The photos stay on your computer.
- **Un-tagging is not deleting.** Removing every tag from a photo just leaves it un-tagged.
- **A tag that no photo uses any more** doesn't get deleted automatically. You can right-click it in the sidebar and choose **Delete tag** to clean it up.

Where your data lives

A quick, plain-language tour of what PicOrg puts where. You don't need to know any of this to use the app — but many people like knowing exactly where their information ends up.

Your photos

Your photos stay where you put them. PicOrg never moves, renames, or changes them. If you added `C:\Users\me\Pictures\Vacation 2024`, that's where the photos still live.

Your tags, titles, and ratings

Whenever you tag a photo, rate it, or give it a title, PicOrg saves that **inside the photo file itself**.

- For **JPEG** photos (`.jpg` , `.jpeg`), the tag is tucked into the same standard place that Windows Explorer, Adobe Lightroom, and other photo apps look. A tag you add in PicOrg immediately shows up in Windows Explorer's *Details* tab too.
- For **PNG** photos (`.png`), the same info is stored inside the PNG file using the widely-supported "XMP" mechanism that Adobe Bridge and digiKam also read.

Your photos still open and look exactly the same — the picture itself isn't touched. Only a small note about the photo is added.

No companion files. PicOrg does **not** create any extra `.xmp` files next to your photos. Everything lives inside the photo.

Photo formats we can't tag yet

Some formats don't have a safe way to embed tags inside them, so PicOrg can't save tags in those files:

- Camera RAW files (`.cr2` , `.cr3` , `.nef` , `.arw` , `.dng` , `.raf` , `.orf` , `.rw2` , `.srw`)
- HEIC / HEIF (iPhone photos)
- TIFF, WebP, GIF, BMP

You'll still see these files in your library — PicOrg can read their EXIF (date, camera) — but if you try to tag or rate one, the app shows a clear message that this format isn't supported for tagging. Your edit isn't lost quietly, and no hidden file is sneakily created.

Legacy .xmp files

If you used an older version of PicOrg or Adobe Lightroom, some of your photos may already have a small `.xmp` companion file next to them. PicOrg still **reads** those on first scan so you don't lose your existing tags. As soon as you save an edit to that photo, PicOrg embeds the new tags into the photo itself and **deletes the leftover .xmp file** — from then on the photo is the single source of truth.

PicOrg's own workshop

PicOrg keeps its own private files in a hidden Windows folder:

```
C:\Users\<you>\AppData\Roaming\com.picorg.picorg\
```

That folder has:

- A little database that remembers what's in your library, so opening the app is instant.
- Small thumbnail images (little versions of your photos) so the grid loads without delay.
- A log file that helps if you ever run into trouble.

None of your original photos live in this folder. You can delete the whole folder if you want — PicOrg will just re-scan your library folders next time you open it.

The three golden rules

1. **PicOrg never moves your photos.** They stay in the folders where you put them.
2. **PicOrg never uploads anything.** No internet, no cloud, no account.
3. **Your tags, titles, and ratings live inside your photos.** So if you copy a photo to another computer, the tags come along for the ride — no extra files needed.

Backing up

To back up your library:

1. **Back up your photo folders.** The tags and ratings are inside the photos themselves — that's everything that matters.
2. **Skip PicOrg's workshop folder.** It's just a cache, and will rebuild itself from your photos.

So an ordinary “copy my Pictures folder to a backup drive” is enough — nothing PicOrg-specific to worry about.

Working with other tools

Your tags, titles, and ratings aren't locked inside PicOrg. Because PicOrg saves them in the standard way — inside the photo file itself — other photo tools can read them too, and PicOrg can read tags added by other tools.

Windows Explorer

- **Tags you add in PicOrg show up in Explorer.** Right-click a photo → **Properties** → **Details** tab. Your tags are in the *Tags* row, your title in *Title*, your rating in *Rating*, your comment in *Comments*.
- **Tags you add in Explorer show up in PicOrg.** After you type a tag in Explorer's Details tab, click **Rescan** in PicOrg (or wait for the next time you click that photo). The tag appears.

Note. Explorer caches things aggressively. If a tag you just added isn't showing, press F5 in the folder or navigate away and back.

Windows Photos app

The built-in Photos app reads titles and ratings that PicOrg wrote. Not all of them are editable there, but you'll see them.

Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Bridge, digiKam

These are photo tools used by pros and enthusiasts. All of them read exactly the same tag/title/rating format PicOrg uses. So a library you tag in PicOrg opens up in Lightroom with everything already labelled — and vice versa.

Some tools cache their view of a folder. If your changes aren't appearing, use the "refresh" or "reload metadata" option in the other tool.

Other tools

Many smaller photo viewers (XnView, FastStone, IrfanView, and so on) can read tags in this standard format too. If your tool has a “read XMP metadata” option, turn it on.

What if I tag a RAW file from my camera?

Camera RAW files (`.CR2` , `.CR3` , `.NEF` , `.ARW` , `.DNG` , `.RAF` , and similar) don’t have a safe standard way to embed tags inside them, so **PicOrg currently can’t save tags on RAW files**. If you try, you’ll see a clear message that this format isn’t supported for tagging.

The same is true for HEIC (iPhone photos), TIFF, WebP, GIF, and BMP files today. Support may grow in future versions.

If you shoot in RAW+JPEG, PicOrg can tag the JPEG version — and those tags are then instantly visible in Windows Explorer, Lightroom, and every other standard tool.

Migrating from an older PicOrg or Lightroom

Earlier PicOrg versions (and Adobe Lightroom for RAW files) sometimes left small `.xmp` companion files next to your photos. PicOrg still reads those on first scan, so you keep your existing tags — but the first time you save an edit, PicOrg embeds the tags into the photo itself and removes the leftover `.xmp` . From that point on, the photo is the only place your tags live.

In short

If your other tool speaks the standard photo-metadata language (and almost every modern one does), it reads and writes the same tags, titles, and ratings PicOrg does. You can move between tools freely without losing your work.

Keyboard shortcuts

You can do everything in PicOrg with a mouse, but keyboard shortcuts make the whole thing much faster once you know them.

Picking photos

Shortcut	What it does
Click	Pick one photo
Ctrl + Click	Add or remove one photo from your selection
Shift + Click	Pick everything between the last click and this one
Ctrl + A	Pick every photo in the current view
Esc	Unpick everything

Moving around

Shortcut	What it does
Arrow keys	Move the cursor around the grid
Home / End	Jump to the first / last photo
Page Up / Page Down	Jump one screen up or down

Titles, ratings, tags

Shortcut	What it does
0	Clear the star rating
1 to 5	Set a 1-to-5-star rating on the selected photos

Shortcut	What it does
Tab (in a title or comment)	Save what you typed and move to the next field
Enter (in the tag box)	Save the tag you just typed
Space (in the tag box)	Save the tag you just typed
Comma (in the tag box)	Save the tag you just typed
Backspace (empty tag box)	Remove the last tag you added

Everyday actions

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + F	Jump to the search box at the top
Ctrl + R	Refresh every folder in your library
Delete	Send the selected photos to the Recycle Bin
Shift + Delete	Delete the selected photos permanently
F1	Open this manual

Layout

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl + B	Show or hide the left-hand sidebar
Ctrl + D	Show or hide the details panel on the right
F11	Full-screen mode (great for browsing)

Troubleshooting

Most bumps you'll hit fall into one of the buckets below. If none of these matches your problem, PicOrg keeps a diary in a log file that can help — the last section explains where to find it.

The app won't open

What happens: You double-click PicOrg and either nothing happens or you get a “WebView2” error message.

Fix: Install the free **Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime** from Microsoft's website. It's a small download. Windows 11 already has it; Windows 10 usually gets it automatically through Windows Update.

Tags I added in File Explorer don't show up in PicOrg

What happens: You right-click a photo in File Explorer, add a tag under **Properties › Details**, but PicOrg's sidebar doesn't list it.

Why: PicOrg only re-reads tags when you tell it to (or when you click the photo). It doesn't watch your folders in the background.

Fix: Click **Rescan** at the top of PicOrg, or right-click the folder in the sidebar and choose **Rescan folder**. The tag will appear.

Tags I added in PicOrg don't show up in File Explorer

What happens: You add a tag in PicOrg, open the photo's properties in File Explorer, and the Tags row is empty.

Fixes to try, in order:

1. **Refresh the Explorer window.** Press **F5** or navigate away and back. Explorer likes to hold onto old data.

2. **Check the file format.** Tags-inside-the-file work for `.jpg`, `.jpeg`, and `.png` photos. Other formats (HEIC, RAW, TIFF, WebP, GIF, BMP) currently can't be tagged — PicOrg tells you so when you try. Convert to JPEG or PNG if you need Explorer to see the tag.
 3. **Check the folder isn't read-only.** If the folder is on a read-only drive (like a locked backup), PicOrg can't save inside the photo. Right-click the folder → **Properties** and make sure *Read-only* is off.
-

Photos are missing from the grid

What happens: A folder has 500 photos in File Explorer but only 480 appear in PicOrg.

Common reasons:

- **Unusual file formats.** PicOrg handles the common ones (JPEG, PNG, GIF, BMP, TIFF, WebP, HEIC) and popular camera RAW files. Others are skipped.
 - **Hidden files.** Files marked as Hidden or System in Windows are skipped on purpose.
 - **A previous scan hit an error.** Right-click the folder → **Rescan folder** to try again.
-

The app is slow / the grid stutters

What to try:

- **Wait for the first scan.** The very first time PicOrg reads a folder it works your CPU hard making thumbnails. Give it a few minutes. Next time you open the app, it'll be instant.
 - **Close other heavy apps.** PicOrg uses your graphics card to draw the grid smoothly. If another app is eating that up, both apps suffer.
 - **Restart PicOrg.** Sometimes the simplest fix.
-

"Save failed" message

What happens: After clicking **Apply tag changes to N photos**, a red **Save failed** message pops up.

Fix: Two common causes:

1. **Folder permissions.** One of the photos lives on a network drive or locked backup. Check that you can write to that folder in File Explorer, then try again.
2. **The photo is in a format we can't tag yet** (RAW, HEIC, TIFF, WebP, GIF, BMP). The error message names the format. Only JPEG and PNG can currently have tags saved inside them.

The log file (see below) will tell you exactly which photo failed.

“This format can't store PicOrg metadata inside the file”

What happens: You add a tag to, say, a `.cr2` RAW file or a `.heic` photo and PicOrg refuses with this message.

Why: Only JPEG and PNG have a safe, standard way to embed tags directly inside the file. PicOrg won't create hidden `.xmp` companion files, so if it can't put your edit *inside* the photo, it won't pretend to save it.

Workarounds:

- Convert (or export a copy of) the photo to JPEG or PNG and tag that copy.
 - If you shoot RAW+JPEG, tag the JPEG version — Lightroom, Bridge, and other tools will read those tags too.
-

Resetting PicOrg

If PicOrg gets into a weird state and you want to start fresh:

1. Close PicOrg.
2. Open File Explorer, paste `%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg` into the address bar, and press Enter.
3. Delete that folder.
4. Reopen PicOrg — it starts empty and you can add your folders again.

Your photos, tags, ratings, and comments are all safe — they live in your photo folders, not in the folder you just deleted.

Finding the log file

PicOrg keeps a diary of everything it does at:

```
%APPDATA%\com.picorg.picorg\logs\picorg.log
```

Open it in Notepad. The bottom of the file is the most recent activity. Lines beginning with **WARN** or **ERROR** are the interesting ones if something went wrong. This is the file to share (or paste into) if you ever report a bug.